Project: Worked examples
Title: Motor start voltage dip and PF correction
Status: DRAFT · Author: TempestOS (2026-10-23) · Checker: — (—) · Issued: —

1. Scope and method

The voltage dip when a three-phase induction motor starts, at the motor terminals and at the point of common coupling, from the supply impedance (a fault level or a transformer), the cable and the motor's locked-rotor impedance for a direct-on-line or star-delta start (a passive motor impedance) or a soft-start or drive start (a regulated current), by the complex potential divider; the dip is checked against a user limit (default 10 %). Also the capacitor kvar to raise the running power factor to a target, the capacitor current and the parallel-resonance order, with a warning when harmonic loads are present. Steady-state phasor model: no motor run-up dynamics, no flicker assessment, no starting-torque adequacy check.

WHAT IT CALCULATES	RELATION
Rated current	$I_n = P/(\sqrt{3}\cdot U\cdot\cos\varphi\cdot\eta)$, or entered
Starting current at rated voltage	DOL $I_{LR}\cdot I_n$; star-delta $I_{LR}\cdot I_n/3$; soft starter $\min(k_{soft}\cdot I_n, I_{LR}\cdot I_n)$; drive $k_{vfd}\cdot I_n$
Motor starting impedance (DOL, star-delta, and a soft starter that does not reach its limit)	$\lvert Z_m\rvert = (U/\sqrt{3})/I_{start}$, for a soft starter $(U/\sqrt{3})/(I_{LR}\cdot I_n)$, at the starting power factor, $Z_m = \lvert Z_m\rvert\cdot(\cos\varphi_{st} + j\sin\varphi_{st})$
Regulated current (a drive; a soft starter when its fully conducting current $E/\lvert Z_s + Z_c + Z_{LR}\rvert$ exceeds $k_{soft}\cdot I_n$)	$\lvert I\rvert = I_{start}$ held, lagging V_m by φ; with $R + jX = Z_s + Z_c$, $a = \lvert I\rvert(R\cos\varphi + X\sin\varphi)$, $b = \lvert I\rvert(X\cos\varphi - R\sin\varphi)$: $\lvert V_m\rvert = \sqrt{(E^2 - b^2)} - a$, $V_{pcc} = V_m + I\cdot Z_c$, and $Z_m = V_m/I$ is the equivalent impedance
Source impedance	transformer $\lvert Z_T\rvert = u_k\cdot U^2/S_n$, plus an optional upstream network $\lvert Z_Q\rvert = U^2/S_{kQ}$ in series; fault level $\lvert Z_s\rvert = c\cdot U^2/S_k$ or $c\cdot U/(\sqrt{3}\cdot I_k)$; each element $Z = \lvert Z\rvert\cdot(1 + j\cdot X/R)/\sqrt{(1 + (X/R)^2)}$
Supply cable impedance	$R = \rho_T\cdot L/(A\cdot n)$ with $\rho_T = \rho_{20}\cdot[1 + \alpha(T_c - 20)]$, or $R'\cdot L/n$; $X = X'\cdot L/n$ (as E3)
Phasor divider for a passive motor (phase voltage $E = U/\sqrt{3}$ at 0°)	$I = E/(Z_s + Z_c + Z_m)$; $V_{pcc} = E\cdot(Z_c + Z_m)/(Z_s + Z_c + Z_m)$; $V_m = E\cdot Z_m/(Z_s + Z_c + Z_m)$
Voltage dip	$100\cdot(1 - \lvert V\rvert/E)$ at the motor terminals and at the point of common coupling; checked against the limits
Cable drop along V_m	$dV_{cab} = \sqrt{3}\cdot\mathrm{Re}[I\cdot Z_c\cdot\bar{V}_m/\lvert V_m\rvert] = \sqrt{3}\cdot I\cdot(R\cos\varphi_{st} + X\sin\varphi_{st})$, the E3 three-phase form at the dipped current
Power-factor correction	$P_{in} = P/\eta$ (or $\sqrt{3}\cdot U\cdot I_n\cdot\cos\varphi$ when I_n is entered), $Q_c = P_{in}\cdot(\tan\varphi_1 - \tan\varphi_2)$ with φ_1 the motor's (a drive's displacement factor with a drive), $I_c = Q_c/(\sqrt{3}\cdot U)$, I after = $P_{in}/(\sqrt{3}\cdot U\cdot\cos\varphi_2)$
Parallel resonance	$S_{sc} = U^2/\lvert Z_s\rvert$, parallel resonance order $h \approx \sqrt{(S_{sc}/Q_c)}$ ($\lvert Z_s\rvert$ used for X_s, so h reads 1 to 1.4 % low)

Basis: Voltage factor c and the equivalent voltage source[1](cl. 5.3); Limitation of voltage changes and flicker in public low-voltage systems (limits are user inputs)[2](scope); Complex impedance and the potential divider[3](Ch. on AC circuits); Power-factor correction: Q = P (tan φ_1 − tan φ_2)[3](Ch. on power factor).

2. Inputs

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
U	Supply and motor rated voltage (line-to-line)	400	V	spec: Site supply SS-1: 400 V three-phase	50 … 1000 V
source	Source impedance from	Transformer		drawing: E-SCH-031 rev A	any
$\text{fault}_{\text{basis}}$	Fault level given as	Fault level S_k (MVA)		default	any
S_k	Three-phase fault level at the point of supply (use the minimum fault level, which gives the deepest dip)	10	MVA	default	0.5 … 500 MVA
I_k	Three-phase fault current at the point of supply (links E5 I_{k3})	15	kA	default	1 … 150 kA
S_n	Transformer rating	500	kVA	spec: Transformer datasheet TR-01: 500 kVA rating plate	25 … 5000 kVA
u_k	Transformer impedance voltage	4	%	reference: record: transformer TR-01 impedance voltage 4 % (rating plate; test value invented for this example)	1 … 12 %
XR_Q	Upstream network X/R ratio	10		default	1 … 50
XR	Source X/R ratio (of the transformer, or of the fault level)	4.2		reference: record: transformer TR-01 X/R 4.2 (from the load-loss figure; test value invented for this example)	0.5 … 40
P	Motor rated output (shaft) power, from the nameplate (E1 P_{cont} is only a lower bound)	75	kW	spec: Pump schedule PS-03: 75 kW motor rated output (test value invented for this example)	0.1 … 2000 kW
η	Motor efficiency at rated load	0.945		spec: Motor datasheet MD-12: 94.5 % at full load (test value invented for this example)	0.5 … 0.99

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
cos_{phi}	Motor power factor at rated load	0.87		spec: Motor datasheet MD-12: 0.87 at full load (test value invented for this example)	0.5 … 1
$I_{LR,r}$	Locked-rotor current ratio I_{LR}/I_n	7		reference: record: motor MD-12 locked-rotor current ratio 7.0 (datasheet; test value invented for this example)	3 … 10
$cos_{phi,st}$	Power factor at locked rotor (starting)	0.3		reference: record: motor MD-12 locked-rotor power factor 0.3 (datasheet; test value invented for this example)	0.1 … 0.8
starter	Starter type	Direct on line (DOL)		drawing: E-SCH-031 rev A	any
k_{soft}	Soft-starter current limit as a multiple of the rated current	3.5		default	1 … 6
k_{vfd}	Drive line-current limit as a multiple of the rated current	1.5		default	0.5 … 2.5
$cos_{phi,vfd}$	Drive line displacement power factor while starting	0.95		default	0.5 … 1
$cable_{data}$	Cable resistance from	resistivity and area		spec: Cable schedule CS-31: resistivity route as E3	any
L_{cab}	Cable length, source to motor (links E4 L)	40	m	drawing: E-LAY-031 rev B	0 … 1000 m
n_{par}	Parallel conductors per phase	1		drawing: E-SCH-031 rev A	1 … 6
A_c	Conductor cross-section (links E4 CSA)	50	mm²	spec: Cable schedule CS-31: 50 mm² copper	1 … 1000 mm²
ρ_{20}	Resistivity at 20 °C (copper 0.01724, aluminium 0.0282 Ω·mm²/m)	0.01724	ohm·mm²/m	reference: record: annealed copper 1.724e-8 Ω·m at 20 °C, derived physical constant	0.01 … 0.05 ohm·mm²/m

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
α	Temperature coefficient of resistance	0.00393	1/K	reference: record: annealed copper, 0.00393 per K at 20 °C, derived physical constant	0.003 … 0.0045 1/K
T_c	Conductor temperature for the resistance	70	°C	assumption: Cable warm from the running load before a restart.	20 … 90 °C
X_{km}	Reactance per km per conductor	0.08	ohm/km	reference: record: cable reactance 0.08 Ω/km (generic value as the E3 default; replace with the cable datasheet figure)	0 … 1 ohm/km
dip_{limit}	Dip limit at the motor terminals	10	%	spec: Machine specification MS-3: motor terminal voltage not below 90 % while starting	1 … 30 %
$dip_{limit,pcc}$	Dip limit at the point of common coupling (when the network operator sets one)	5	%	spec: Connection agreement CA-2: 5 % at the point of common coupling (test value invented for this example)	0.5 … 20 %
cos_{phi2}	Target power factor after correction	0.95		spec: Connection agreement CA-2: power factor not below 0.95	0.8 … 1
harmonics	Harmonic loads present on the supply	no		assumption: No drives or other harmonic loads on the supply.	any

3. Assumptions

A1. The supply is a stiff source behind the stated impedance (voltage E = U/√3 before the start). A direct-on-line or star-delta start, and a soft starter that does not reach its current limit at the dipped voltage (full conduction), draw current through a passive winding: a constant impedance equal to the locked-rotor impedance at rated voltage and the starting power factor, so the current falls with the dipped voltage. A soft starter that reaches its limit and a drive regulate the current: they hold $|I| = I_{start}$ whatever the voltage, so the dip is deeper than the passive model gives; the current phasor lags the voltage at the starter or drive input by the stated power factor. (Standard steady-state starting-dip screening model; the regulated case is solved in closed form.)
A2. The dip is the steady-state phasor value at the instant of locked rotor; the current falls as the motor accelerates, so the dip is the worst case. No other load is running on the supply and no run-up dynamics,

flicker (Pst) or tap-changer action is assessed. (Stated limitation.)
A3. A star-delta start draws one third of the direct-on-line current at rated voltage (and one third of the starting torque, which is not checked here); the current spike at the star-to-delta changeover is not modelled. (Star-delta connection ratio.)
A4. The cable resistance follows E3: from the resistivity, area and temperature, or from R′ per kilometre; X′ per kilometre is a user or record value. No cable table is embedded. (User or record values.)
A5. The capacitor kvar corrects the running power factor of the motor input power P/η at rated load; the capacitor sits at the point of common coupling, and the resonance order uses the short-circuit apparent power $U^2/|Z_s|$ there ($|Z_s|$ stands in for X_s, so h reads 1 to 1.4 % low). Capacitor switching, detuning and self-excitation on disconnection are not assessed. (Standard power-factor-correction relation.)
A6. Source: E5 'Z_s' and 'I_f' are earth-fault-loop quantities (line to earth through the protective conductor), not the positive-sequence source impedance a motor start sees, so they are not linked; the fault level links E5 I_{k3}. E5 computes I_{k3} with c = 1.1 and $U_n = \sqrt{3}\cdot U_0$ (398.4 V at 230 V), so the I_k basis defaults c to 1.1 and U should be $\sqrt{3}\cdot U_0$ for an exact match with E5's Z_T. E6 declares no impedance port, so the transformer rating and impedance are entered. (Linking decision.)
A7. The source impedance should be taken at the minimum fault level (the deepest dip); a transformer alone is an infinite bus behind it, which understates the dip by a few per cent and overstates the resonance order unless the upstream network fault level S_{kQ} is entered. (Stated limitation.)
A8. With a drive, the power-factor correction starts from the drive's displacement factor, not the motor's, the drive is itself a harmonic load, and the 'torque factor' and the voltage at the starter or drive input (not the motor terminals) are reported only for what they are. (Regulated-current starters.)
A9. T_c (Conductor temperature for the resistance) is taken as 70 degC. (Cable warm from the running load before a restart.)
A10. harmonics (Harmonic loads present on the supply) is taken as no. (No drives or other harmonic loads on the supply.)

4. Working

[10] I_{rated} = P / (sqrt(3) * U * $\cos_{phi}$ * η)
= 75 kW / (sqrt(3) × 400 V × 0.87 × 0.945)
= 131.67 A
Motor rated current from the rated output

[13] I_{start} = $I_{LR,r}$ * I_{rated}
= 7 × 131.67 A
= 921.7 A
Starting current at rated voltage (direct on line, locked rotor)

[14] S_{start} = sqrt(3) * U * I_{start}
= sqrt(3) × 400 V × 921.7 A
= 638.57 kVA
Starting apparent power

[18] Z_T = u_k * U^2 / S_n
= 4 % × (400 V)^2 / 500 kVA
= 0.0128 ohm
Source impedance magnitude from the transformer

[19] R_{src} = Z_T / sqrt(1 + XR^2)
= 0.0128 ohm / sqrt(1 + 4.2^2)
= 0.0029647 ohm
Source resistance

[20] X_{src} = R_{src} * XR
= 0.0029647 ohm × 4.2
= 0.012452 ohm
Source reactance

[21] Z_{src} = hypot(R_{src}, X_{src})
= hypot(0.0029647 ohm, 0.012452 ohm)
= 0.0128 ohm
Source impedance magnitude
[29] ρ_T = ρ_{20} * (1 + α * (T_c - 20 degC))
= 0.01724 ohm·mm²/m × (1 + 0.00393 1/K × (70 degC - 20 degC))
= 0.020628 ohm·mm²/m
Resistivity at the operating temperature
[30] R_{cab} = ρ_T * L_{cab} / (A_c * n_{par})
= 0.020628 ohm·mm²/m × 40 m / (50 mm² × 1)
= 0.016502 ohm
Cable resistance (parallel paths combined)
[31] X_{cab} = X_{km} * L_{cab} / n_{par}
= 0.08 ohm/km × 40 m / 1
= 0.0032 ohm
Cable reactance
[32] Z_m = U / (sqrt(3) * I_{start})
= 400 V / (sqrt(3) × 921.7 A)
= 0.25056 ohm
Motor starting impedance magnitude
[33] R_m = Z_m * $cos_{phi,st}$
= 0.25056 ohm × 0.3
= 0.075168 ohm
Motor starting resistance
[34] X_m = Z_m * sqrt(1 - $cos_{phi,st}$^2)
= 0.25056 ohm × sqrt(1 - 0.3^2)
= 0.23902 ohm
Motor starting reactance
[35] E_{ph} = E = U/√3 (reference phasor, angle 0°)
= 400 V / √3
= 230.94 V
Source phase voltage before the start
[36] $Z_{s,ph}$ = Z_s = R_s + jX_s
= R_s = 0.0029647 Ω, X_s = 0.012452 Ω
= "0.0029647 + j0.012452 Ω [0.0128 Ω ∠ 76.608°]"
Source impedance phasor
[37] $Z_{c,ph}$ = Z_c = R_c + jX_c
= R_c = 0.016502 Ω, X_c = 0.0032 Ω
= "0.016502 + j0.0032 Ω [0.01681 Ω ∠ 10.974°]"
Cable impedance phasor
[38] $Z_{m,ph}$ = Z_m = |Z_m|·(cos φ_{st} + j sin φ_{st})
= 0.25056 Ω · (0.3 + j0.95394)
= "0.075168 + j0.23902 Ω [0.25056 Ω ∠ 72.542°]"
Motor starting impedance phasor
[39] $Z_{t,ph}$ = Z_t = Z_s + Z_c + Z_m
= (0.0029647 + j0.012452) + (0.016502 + j0.0032) + (0.075168 + j0.23902)
= "0.094635 + j0.25467 Ω [0.27169 Ω ∠ 69.615°]"
Total series impedance phasor
[40] I_{ph} = I = E/Z_t
= 230.94 V / (0.27169 Ω ∠ 69.615°)
= "296.09 - j796.79 A [850.03 A ∠ -69.615°]"
Starting current phasor at the dipped voltage

[41] $V_{m,ph} = V_m = E \cdot Z_m / Z_t$
= 230.94 V · (0.25056 Ω ∠ 72.542°) / (0.27169 Ω ∠ 69.615°)
= "212.7 + j10.877 V [212.98 V ∠ 2.9273°]"
Motor terminal voltage phasor (phase)
[42] $V_{pcc,ph} = V_{pcc} = E \cdot (Z_c + Z_m) / Z_t$
= 230.94 V · (0.25899 Ω ∠ 69.27°) / (0.27169 Ω ∠ 69.615°)
= "220.14 − j1.3245 V [220.14 V ∠ -0.34473°]"
Point of common coupling voltage phasor (phase)
[43] $I_{dip} = |I|$
= 230.94 V / 0.27169 Ω
= 850.03 A
Starting current at the dipped voltage
[44] $V_m = |V_m| \cdot \sqrt{3}$
= 212.98 V · √3
= 368.9 V
Voltage at the motor terminals while starting (line)
[45] $V_{pcc} = |V_{pcc}| \cdot \sqrt{3}$
= 220.14 V · √3
= 381.3 V
Point of common coupling voltage while starting (line)
[46] $start_{dip} = 100 \cdot (1 - |V_m| / E)$
= 100 · (1 − 212.98 / 230.94)
= 7.7757 %
Voltage dip at the motor terminals
[47] $dip_{pcc} = 100 \cdot (1 - |V_{pcc}| / E)$
= 100 · (1 − 220.14 / 230.94)
= 4.6746 %
Voltage dip at the point of common coupling
[48] $dV_{cab} = \sqrt{3} \cdot \mathrm{Re}[I \cdot Z_c \cdot \bar{V}_m / |V_m|]$
= √3 · Re[(850.03 A ∠ -69.615°) · (0.01681 Ω ∠ 10.974°) · e^(-j2.9273°)]
= 11.783 V
Cable drop along the starting voltage: √3·I·(R cos φ + X sin φ), the E3 three-phase form at this current
[49] $k_T = (|V_m| / E)^2$
= (212.98 / 230.94)²
= 0.85053
Torque factor at the dipped voltage relative to rated voltage (torque varies as V²)
[50] $u_{dip} = start_{dip} / dip_{limit}$
= 7.7757 % / 10 %
= 0.77757
Dip at the motor terminals against the limit
[51] $P_{in} = P / \eta$
= 75 kW / 0.945
= 79.365 kW
Motor input power at rated load
[52] $tan_1 = sqrt(1 - cos_{phi}^2) / cos_{phi}$
= sqrt(1 − 0.87^2) / 0.87
= 0.56673
tan φ_1 at the running power factor
[53] $tan_2 = sqrt(1 - cos_{phi2}^2) / cos_{phi2}$
= sqrt(1 − 0.95^2) / 0.95
= 0.32868
tan φ_2 at the target power factor

[54] Q_c = max(0 kW, P_{in} * (tan_1 - tan_2))
= max(0 kW, 79.365 kW × (0.56673 - 0.32868))
= 18.892 kvar
Capacitor kvar to reach the target power factor
[55] I_{cap} = Q_c / (sqrt(3) * U)
= 18.892 kvar / (sqrt(3) × 400 V)
= 27.269 A
Capacitor line current at rated voltage
[56] I_{run1} = P_{in} / (sqrt(3) * U * cos_{phi})
= 79.365 kW / (sqrt(3) × 400 V × 0.87)
= 131.67 A
Running line current before correction
[57] I_{run2} = P_{in} / (sqrt(3) * U * cos_{phi2})
= 79.365 kW / (sqrt(3) × 400 V × 0.95)
= 120.58 A
Running line current after correction (when the target is reached)
[58] S_{sc} = U^2 / Z_{src}
= (400 V)^2 / 0.0128 ohm
= 12.5 MVA
Short-circuit apparent power at the point of supply
[59] h_{res} = sqrt(S_{sc} / Q_c)
= sqrt(12.5 MVA / 18.892 kvar)
= 25.723
Parallel resonance order of the capacitor bank with the supply
[61] $u_{dip,pcc}$ = dip_{pcc} / $dip_{limit,pcc}$
= 4.6746 % / 5 %
= 0.93491
Point-of-common-coupling dip against the limit

5. Results

SYMBOL	VALUE	DESCRIPTION
Z_{src}	0.0128 ohm	Source impedance (magnitude)
Z_m	0.25056 ohm	Motor starting impedance (magnitude)
I_{rated}	131.67 A	Motor rated current
I_{start}	921.7 A	Starting current at rated voltage
S_{start}	638.57 kVA	Starting apparent power
I_{dip}	850.03 A	Starting current at the dipped voltage
V_m	368.9 V	Voltage at the motor terminals while starting
V_{pcc}	381.3 V	Point of common coupling voltage while starting
$start_{dip}$	7.7757 %	Voltage dip at the motor terminals
dip_{pcc}	4.6746 %	Voltage dip at the point of common coupling
dV_{cab}	11.783 V	Cable drop along the starting voltage
k_T	0.85053	Torque factor at the dipped voltage
u_{dip}	0.77757	Dip utilisation at the motor terminals
P_{in}	79.365 kW	Motor input power at rated load
kvar	18.892 kvar	Capacitor kvar to the target power factor

SYMBOL	VALUE	DESCRIPTION
I_{cap}	27.269 A	Capacitor current
I_{run1}	131.67 A	Running current before correction
I_{run2}	120.58 A	Running current after correction
S_{sc}	12.5 MVA	Short-circuit apparent power at the bank
h_{res}	25.723	Parallel resonance order
$u_{dip,pcc}$	0.93491	Point-of-common-coupling dip utilisation

6. Checks (governing first)

RESULT	CHECK	DEMAND	CAPACITY	UTILISATION	REF
PASS	Point-of-common-coupling dip within the limit	$u_{dip,pcc} = 0.93491$	$u_{dip,pcc} \le 1$	0.935	[2](scope)
PASS	Motor-terminal dip within the limit	$u_{dip} = 0.77757$	$u_{dip} \le 1$	0.778	

7. Applicability

WARNING — record: Tabulated values not taken from a reference record: X_{km} (Cable resistance and reactance per kilometre); ρ_{20}, α (Conductor material constants); $I_{LR,r}$, $\cos_{phi,st}$ (Motor starting data); u_k, XR (Transformer impedance data). Enter each as one so its source, edition and licence travel with it.
WARNING — input.fault_basis: $fault_{basis}$ (Fault level given as) was not entered; the template default 'Fault level S_k (MVA)' is used.
WARNING — input.S_k: S_k (Three-phase fault level at the point of supply (use the minimum fault level, which gives the deepest dip)) was not entered; the template default 10 MVA is used.
WARNING — input.I_k: I_k (Three-phase fault current at the point of supply (links E5 I_{k3})) was not entered; the template default 15 kA is used.
WARNING — input.XR_Q: XR_Q (Upstream network X/R ratio) was not entered; the template default 10 is used.
WARNING — input.k_soft: k_{soft} (Soft-starter current limit as a multiple of the rated current) was not entered; the template default 3.5 is used.
WARNING — input.k_vfd: k_{vfd} (Drive line-current limit as a multiple of the rated current) was not entered; the template default 1.5 is used.
WARNING — input.cos_phi_vfd: $\cos_{phi,vfd}$ (Drive line displacement power factor while starting) was not entered; the template default 0.95 is used.

8. Verification

```
Template elec.motor-start@1.2.1 Content hash 66f32fca1f51bd3a Engine calc-engine/1.0.0
Known-answer cases passed 8/8 Test run 2026-10-23 12:00 UTC TempestOS 0.26.0
```

9. References

1. IEC 60909-0.
2. IEC 61000-3-11.
3. Hughes E. Hughes Electrical and Electronic Technology. 12th ed. Pearson; 2016.